James Flynn

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Professional Summary

Product leader with 15 years building products and product organizations at Google, Samsung, and venture-backed startups. Two exits. At Google, led AI integration into expert workflows, human-reviewable AI systems with decision tracing, and cut key consent design stages from months to hours. Before that, PM for the "Hey Google" hotword and Voice Match biometric models serving 100M+ users: ran offline evals across pronunciation, noise, and simulated devices, tracked live false-reject and imposter-accept signals, and invented and deployed a feature that cut invocation false accepts by >10%. Engineer by training (FPGA/ASIC, signal processing); three US patents plus a pending Google hotword patent.

Skills

Global Privacy Regulation · AI Workflow Implementation in Regulated Sectors · Human-Reviewable AI & Decision Tracing · Model Evals: Offline Suites & Live Metrics · Experimentation & Multi-Arm Testing · Human-Rated Tasks & Inter-Rater Agreement · Speech & Biometric AI Products · Developer Platforms · Product Orgs · Product and GTM Strategy · AI Accelerated Software and Firmware · iOS, Android, Google ADK · UX Design for PMF Discovery, Demand Validation, User Journey Success

Work Experience

Aston Research LLC — Principal Consultant — Multiple Clients
Boston, MA | March 2026 – Present

- Client 1 - Led product strategy reboot; realigned and mobilized Series A company around new goals and an operating model built for product-market-fit discovery - Owned product vision, strategy, and roadmap across connected hardware and software.
- Client 2 - Determined product, brand direction via marketing experiment design for demand validation.

Google — Senior Product Manager, Privacy & Consent (Google Core)
Cambridge, MA | January 2024 – March 2026

- Led AI integration for privacy consent workflows: studied expert workflows, encoded internal expertise, and automated requirements analysis with detailed decision tracing for human review, cutting key consent design stages from months to hours
- Led design of internal data classification taxonomy
- Built AI Consent Design: automated generation of compliant, UX- and business-optimized consent designs, including a prototype generator for global jurisdiction variants, replacing a fully manual process; packaged as a self-serve platform with adoption and efficiency KPIs
- Directed and specified user research programs across Google's first-party products, combining offline survey-based research with online multi-arm experiments, and ran the data analysis for early project impact evaluation
- Owned redesign and synchronized relaunch of the Google DMA consent flow across YouTube, Search, Play, and Google Ads after supporting negotiations with the European Commission and Italian Consumer Authority, impacting ~50M users annually across the EU

Google — Senior Product Manager, Speech Recognition (Google Assistant)
Cambridge, MA | April 2020 – December 2023

- Owned product strategy, onboarding, privacy, trust, and compliance for voice invocation and biometric voice identification for 100M+ global users
- PM for the "Hey Google" / "OK Google" hotword models across dozens of global variants; evaluated new models with offline tests covering pronunciation distributions, noise types, and simulated devices (earbuds, smart speakers, displays, phones), and tracked live retries (a near-trigger followed shortly by a successful trigger) as a signal of first-attempt false rejects; co-inventor on pending patent application "Hotwording by Degree" (US20240331683A1)
- Ran the Voice Match biometric ID models that personalize features and access for individual users: offline evals, adaptation so models improved with continued use, and live imposter-accept tracking (two different Voice Match models on the same device both returning a match)
- Devised and launched a novel false-accept mitigation feature using behavioral and environmental signals, driving a >10% reduction in invocation false accepts; improved voice ID enrollment completion by 5%
- Expanded biometric voice ID from Assistant to all Google products, including Gemini; built a self-serve contextual biasing platform adopted by more than 30 internal Google teams

Aston Research LLC — Principal Consultant — Multiple Clients
Cambridge, MA | December 2018 – April 2020

- Client 1, IDEO. Feasibility analysis and new product prototype for a Fortune 100 energy company
- Client 2, Samsung. Identified and sized product opportunities in home fitness consumer electronics
- Client 3, Anthem Health. Product org redesign for Anthem's mobile application for health advice and claims tracking.

Techcombank — VP, Digital Banking
Hanoi, Vietnam | October 2016 – December 2018

- Led digital transformation for retail banking; designed and established the bank's first cross-functional product team, overcoming significant institutional friction to build agile product development capability from scratch

Samsung Next — Director, Technology & Product
San Francisco, CA | September 2013 – September 2016

- Built a cross-functional team from scratch that developed 7 products into user trials in 18 months, shutting down all but one based on experimental outcomes
- "CEO Founder" of the team behind the Samsung Family Hub hero app, a family coordination app with a large wall-mounted touchscreen, from concept through acquisition by Samsung
- Offered Product Lead position at Samsung America's Product Innovation Team post acquisition.

Extrasensory Devices — Founder
Palo Alto, CA | June 2011 – September 2013

- Founded a hardware + software startup pairing mobile apps with hardware accessories; company acquired. First product, a photographic light meter accessory and app, raised $120K on Kickstarter (homepage feature); co-inventor, patent US9291880 (assigned to SparkFactor Design)

Wideband Semi / Zeiss Meditec — FPGA/ASIC Engineer
Bay Area, CA | July 1999 – June 2011

- DSP and control logic design for communications and medical device FPGAs and ASICs; co-inventor on Wideband Semiconductor patents US7945780 and US7995622

Projects

Online Labour Market Experiments (Harvard Business School, with labor economist Zoe Cullen) (2017 – 2019) https://github.com/zcullen/otree Designed and built experiments in Python on oTree platform for online labor-market studies: designed a multi-round human transcription task with consent flow, qualification screening, payoff logic, and inter-rater negotiation, using Amazon MechanicalTurk

Education

- **Program for Leadership Development (PLD)** Harvard Business School, Boston, MA, Jan 2025
- **Bachelor of Science (Hons), Physics** University of Canterbury, New Zealand, May 1998

Certifications

- **Certified Information Privacy Technologist (CIPT)** — IAPP, 2024